



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: A Date To Remember



Learning Outcome

Describe characteristics of different people and their jobs.

Ask your partner:

- Have you been on a date before?
- Where did you go? To the movies? Out for dinner?

Can Do Statements

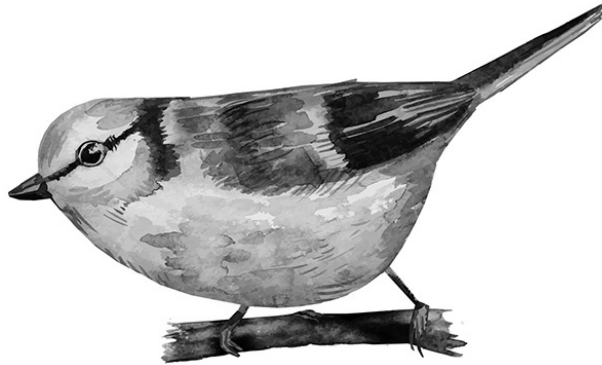
- I can write a descriptive paragraph.
- I can describe people's appearance and personality.
- I can say what I was doing when something else happened.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa writes an e-mail to Sally about her date with Marco.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Subject Line - A Date To Remember

Hey Sally,

I had to tell you about my date last Saturday.

Marco and I went for a hike up Table Ridge Mountain. I was waiting in the parking lot for half an hour before he arrived. I was a little bothered, but when he showed up with a single, red rose, I forgave him immediately.

Marco's so sweet. Have I told you how athletic he is too? I'm sure he must spend a lot of time in the gym. He was taking two steps at a time while I struggled to catch my breath. We were winding our way to the top when we heard a strange noise in the bushes. There, we found a blue jay with a broken wing.

Marco took off his shirt and wrapped up the bird. We decided to head back down the mountain to find a vet. Sally, he was so tender and gentle with the injured animal. What an angel!

Chat soon,
Vanessa





Let's Practice!

Time to practice writing a descriptive paragraph. Can you use the Past Continuous and Past tenses together?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Fill in the blank with the missing word. Use: heard, struggled, and waiting.

1. He was taking the steps two at a time while I _____ to catch my breath.
2. We were winding our way to the top when we _____ a strange noise in the bushes.
3. I was _____ in the parking lot for half an hour before he arrived.



Let's Practice!

Tell us about Marco. What is he like?

Read each clue. Check off the correct square.

1. Marco's so sweet.
2. Have I told you how athletic he is too?
3. I was a little bothered.
4. He was gentle with the injured bird.
5. What an angel!





Extension Activity

Tell us about the people around you. Write a descriptive paragraph about a friend.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 75-word descriptive paragraph about a friend.
- Include information about their appearance and personality.
- Use simple, compound and complex sentences.
- Use paragraph structure.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a descriptive paragraph about a friend.

☐ ☐

I use proper sentence structure.

☐ ☐

I proofread my work.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **parking lot** (noun): an area outside a building for parking cars and trucks
e.g. Vanessa waited in the parking lot.
- **to bother** (verb): to cause someone to feel worried, annoyed or concerned
e.g. Vanessa was a little bothered.
- **tender** (adjective): very loving and gentle; showing affection and love for someone or something
e.g. Marco was very tender with the bird.
- **angel** (noun): a spiritual being that is a messenger from God
e.g. He is such an angel!
- **to struggle** (verb): to try very hard to do, achieve, or deal with something that is difficult or that causes problems
e.g. Vanessa struggled to keep up with Marco.
- **to wind** (verb): to follow a series of curves and turns
e.g. We were winding our way to the top.
- **wing** (noun): a part of an animal's body that is used for flying or gliding
e.g. The bird's wing was broken.
- **catch my breath** (expression): use when you find it difficult to breathe
e.g. Vanessa needed to catch her breath.





Learning Points

Writing a Descriptive Paragraph

When you write a descriptive paragraph, use different types of sentences.

There are four sentence types:

Simple

Simple sentences do not have conjunctions (and, but, or).

Example: Marco climbed the mountain.

Compound

Compound sentences have two statements that are connected by a conjunction.

Example: Vanessa waited in the parking lot and Marco had a coffee.

Complex

A complex sentence has one complete sentence (independent clause) and at least one incomplete sentence (dependent clause).

The two clauses are connected by a word like *which, who, although, if, or since*.

Example: If you turn left at the intersection, you will see the mountain ahead of you.

Compound - Complex

A compound-complex sentence contains at least one dependent clause and more than one independent clause.

Example: Marco, who arrived last month, met his co-worker, and then he decided to take her on a date.

The Past Tense and Past Continuous Tenses

You make the Past Continuous tense by using the Past tense of the verb **to be** and the -ing form of the verb.

You use the Past Continuous tense to talk about:

1. something which continued before and after another action

Example: Marco and Vanessa were climbing up the mountain when they heard a noise in the bush.

2. something that happened before and after a time period

Example: It was eight o'clock. I was writing a letter.

3. something that continued for some time

Example: My knee was aching.

4. something that was happening again and again

Example: I was jogging every day, three times a day.

